



CITY OF CHICAGO



DEPARTMENT OF FINANCE

July 28, 2026

Jared Meyer
jaredthomasmeyer@gmail.com

Dear Jared Meyer,

On the behalf of the City of Chicago Department of Finance (“DOF”), I am responding to your Freedom of Information Act (“FOIA”) request sent on July 20, 2026 and received by DOF on July 21, 2026, seeking records to the following:

“Re: Freedom of Information Act request — Smart Streets pilot program violation data Dear FOIA Officer, Under the Illinois Freedom of Information Act, 5 ILCS 140, I request copies of the following records of the Smart Streets pilot program (the automated camera enforcement of bike lane, bus lane, and bus stop violations authorized by the Smart Streets Pilots ordinance passed by City Council on March 15, 2023, and administered by the Department of Finance with the Department of Transportation). Each item is independent — a partial response is welcome, and for any dataset an export of the existing database or spreadsheet in its native structured format (CSV or Excel, not scanned images or PDFs of records) is preferable to any newly created document. 1. Violation-level records of all warnings and citations issued under the Smart Streets pilot from November 1, 2024 through the date this request is processed, including for each record, as maintained: date and time of violation; location (address, block, or intersection); violation type (bike lane, bus lane, or bus stop); whether a warning or a citation was issued; fine amount assessed and disposition/payment status; the name of the registered owner for vehicles registered to businesses or commercial fleets; and ward or any other geographic identifier maintained. 2. The compiled dataset or summary of Smart Streets violations by vehicle owner that was produced in response to the records request underlying the Chicago Tribune's July 19, 2026 report on delivery-company fines (Amazon Logistics, FedEx, UPS). As this production has already been compiled and released, I request a copy of the same records. 3. The data dictionary, field list, or record layout for the citation database as it pertains to Smart Streets violations, sufficient to interpret the fields in item 1. To expedite processing: I do not object to the redaction of personal identifying information of private individual registrants under 5 ILCS 140/7(1)(b)–(c). Business and commercial-fleet registrant names are not private information and have already been publicly disclosed in press reporting on this program. I request a waiver of fees under 5 ILCS 140/6: this request is made for noncommercial purposes in connection with an open-source, publicly available civic project (“On Your Left!”) that publishes Chicago bike-safety data for public benefit, and disclosure serves the public interest. Separately from this request: if Smart Streets violation data is something the City would consider publishing on the Data Portal on an ongoing basis — as it already does for the older Speed Camera Violations and Red-Light Camera Violations datasets — we would enthusiastically use and publicize it, and a recurring portal dataset would spare your office future one-off requests like this one. Electronic delivery to this email address is preferred.”



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Pursuant to 5 ILCS/140, you will find information pertaining to your request enclosed in accordance with the FOIA Act through GOVQA at the following entries Department of Finance (F146238-072126).

Please be advised DOF withheld the responsive records in compliance with FOIA. Specifically, personal license plates were withheld. Section 7(1)(b) exempts from disclosure "private information." 5 ILCS 140/7(1)(b). Private information is defined in Section 2(c-5) as: unique identifiers, including a person's social security number, driver's license number, employee identification number, biometric identifiers, personal financial information, passwords or other access codes, medical records, home or personal telephone numbers, and personal email addresses. Private information also includes home address and personal license plates, except as otherwise provided by law or when compiled without possibility of attribution to any person. 5 ILCS 140/2(c-5). Therefore, these identifiers were properly redacted pursuant to Section 7(1)(b) of FOIA. The material that has been redacted under this section is the address of the person who received each delinquent ticket. The release of this information would constitute an unwarranted invasion of personal privacy. Therefore, this material has been properly redacted.

In addition, such identifiers are exempt from disclosure pursuant to Section 7(1)(c) of FOIA. Section 7(1)(c) exempts from disclosure: [p]ersonal information contained within public records, the disclosure of which would constitute a clearly unwarranted invasion of personal privacy [...] 'Unwarranted invasion of personal privacy' means the disclosure of information that is highly personal or objectionable to a reasonable person and in which the subject's right to privacy outweighs any legitimate public interest in obtaining the information. 5 ILCS 140/7(1)(c). DOF properly withheld the address of the person who received each delinquent ticket pursuant to Section 7(1)(c).

In addition, DOF also withheld license plates as such information is highly private. License plate numbers do not significantly reflect public duties or a matter of significant public interest, and its release would be objectionable to a reasonable person. Accordingly, disclosure of this information would be an unwarranted invasion of privacy.

To the extent that your FOIA request has been denied, you have a right of review by the Illinois Attorney General's Public Access Counselor, who can be contacted at 500 S. Second St., Springfield, IL 62706 or by telephone at (217)558-0486. You may also seek judicial review of a denial under 5 ILCS 140/11 of FOIA.

Sincerely,

April Lundberg

April Lundberg

FOIA Officer

Policy and Legislation - City of Chicago Department of Finance

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